Max Cupsa

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley - Haas School of Business **Expected: May 2029**
B.S. in Business Administration **GPA: 3.7 | SAT: 1550**
Relevant Coursework: Microeconomic Analysis for Business Decisions, Principles of Business, Data and Decisions, Principles of Data Science, Principles of Economics, and Calculus II & III

WORK EXPERIENCE

Fireclay Partners **July 2026 - Present**
Investment Banking Summer Analyst *Kansas City, MO*
- Defined the coverage universe for a B2B industrial and facility services vertical by building a detailed in-scope/out-of-scope taxonomy across six subverticals to focus deal sourcing and target screening.
- Constructed a public comparable companies coverage book of 10 companies spread across subverticals and market size to benchmark valuation and map the industry framework onto private acquisition targets.
- Analyzed EV/EBITDA trading multiples ranging from ~10x to ~30x, tying valuation premiums to route density, recurring revenue mix, and mandated spend to isolate the key drivers of business quality.
- Positioned private targets along the public comparable "valuation ladder" by evaluating recurring revenue mix, cyclicality, and service durability to inform pricing and deal positioning.
- Supported an active sell-side M&A engagement by preparing comparable-company and positioning materials used in live meetings with a prospective private equity buyer.

Watercress Capital **June 2026 - July 2026**
Investment Banking Summer Analyst *Memphis, TN*
- Constructed Financial Summaries (Profit & Loss and Balance Sheet) for target companies using corporate tax returns to assess financial health.
- Formulated targeted company questionnaires based on historical financial and trend analysis to uncover operational insights and mitigate transaction risks.
- Normalized historical earnings by identifying, calculating, and integrating key non-business expenses to determine true Adjusted EBITDA and company valuation.
- Developed dynamic financial dashboards for multiple acquisition targets to compare future growth rates, valuation structures, and debt service coverage for potential acquisitions.
- Drafted key deal documentation, including Letters of Intent (LOIs) and formal Purchase Proposals for deal negotiations.
- Built a comprehensive Confidential Information Memorandum with detailed company analysis, executive summary, industry outlook, and financial models.

Oxford University **June 2024 - October 2024**
Research Associate *Oxford, United Kingdom*
- Researched M&A strategy in technology and pharmaceutical sectors with Dr. Alexei Parakhonyak, focusing on killer acquisitions, where large incumbents acquire emerging competitors to protect market position.
- Built a two-period game-theoretic model of incumbent–entrant R&D competition, solving the subgame-perfect equilibrium by backward induction to link competition intensity and market size to acquisition premiums and deal-structuring rationale.

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

Ascend Berkeley Chapter **February 2026 - Present**
Investment Banking Committee Member *Berkeley, CA*
- Hosted the “Break into Banking” Investment Banking panel with 4 bankers at the Vice President level and above and had 120+ UC Berkeley students in attendance.
- Attended weekly technical workshops so far covering comparable company analysis, and precedent transactions, building proficiency in core valuation methodologies.
- Developed equity investment theses and valuation models, presenting stock pitches and discussing portfolio positioning.

Ukraine Refugee Integration Assistance Inc. **September 2022 - December 2025**
Founder and President *Long Island, NY and Cluj-Napoca, Romania*
- Connected over 35 Ukrainian children with peers worldwide, creating cross-cultural conversations.
- Raised more than $25,000 to directly support hospitals, shelters, and soup kitchens in Ukraine and Romania.
- Delivered a keynote address at the Romanian Embassy in Washington, DC, talking about the impact of URIA’s work on refugee integration and international cooperation.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Languages and Skills: Romanian (Fluent), Mandarin (Beginner), Python, Excel, PowerPoint, Bloomberg Market Concepts
Interests: Tennis, Skiing, Film, Weightlifting, Cooking, Watches